

6. Differentiation

What students need to learn:

Differentiation of e^x , $\ln x$, $\sin x$, $\cos x$, $\tan x$ and their sums and differences.

Differentiation using the product rule, the quotient rule and the chain rule.

The use of $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{1}{\left(\frac{dx}{dy}\right)}$.

Differentiation of simple functions defined implicitly or parametrically.

Exponential growth and decay.

Formation of simple differential equations.

Differentiation of $\operatorname{cosec} x$, $\cot x$ and $\sec x$ are required. Skill will be expected in the differentiation of functions generated from standard forms using products, quotients and composition, such as

$2x^4 \sin x$, $\frac{e^{3x}}{x}$, $\cos x^2$ and $\tan^2 2x$.

E.g. finding $\frac{dy}{dx}$ for $x = \sin 3y$.

The finding of equations of tangents and normals to curves given parametrically or implicitly is required.

Knowledge and use of the result

$\frac{d}{dx}(a^x) = a^x \ln a$ is expected.

Questions involving connected rates of change may be set.
